



Open Office vs MS Office

"Open Office vs. MS Office" fight is on, may the fittest survive

No change

Users are tired of Facebook's constant UI meddling, is anyone listening?

TECH THAT DIED

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For every technology, game, service or web site that makes it to the A-list, there are others that never do. Here, we look at technologies, games, services and web sites, and try to see what caused their downfall, all with a splash of good, harmless fun poked at their expense.

Age of Empires

At one point, every time someone mentioned the term "strategy," the first thing that came to our minds was *Age of Empires* (AoE). The kind of dedicated fan following it afforded was just unparalleled. Everyone abandoned TV, movies stayed on the shelf – all you dreamt and breathed was the idea of conquest, of capturing more and more land and an obscenely long gaming session culminating in a winner's screen with a statistical representation of your mad skills at the game and overall blinding awesomeness.

However, the novelty waned shockingly fast. By the time *Age of Empires III: The Asian Dynasties* was released, most of the



cult followers had become disillusioned with the franchise. Even though sales figures would suggest that everything was right with the world, the game never managed to create the mass hysteria that its predecessor did back in the day. Most of us were just left with an air of nostalgia and fading memories of vindictive victory,

Everything in the world of technology comes with an expiry date, some things more than others.

and we make no qualms about still firing up the good old *Age of Empires* every once in a while and play till we whoosh past every professional and personal deadline. What? We're building an empire after all. And in this world, we are the Kings of our castle.

Replaced by: Other games that managed to create a cult fan following, such as Sims and Civilization.

Bhuvan

Why are we talking about all this you ask? Because despite all the odds, ISRO has managed to replicate an embarrassing dud on the web now – Bhuvan. Apparently, Google Earth caught someone's fancy in the organisation, and thought of beating Google at their own game!

If you haven't used Bhuvan yet, don't! For the stubborn ones, you can download a plug-in, or use it via the browser in the same way that Google's Maps works – unfortunately, that is where the similarity ends. The web interface looks like a cheap rip-off of Google Maps, the progress bar is forever stuck at loading, and it's the polar opposite of a "smooth web experience". The advertised zoom level of up to 10 metres from the surface of the Earth is just hogwash.

Replaced by: Nothing. Thank God!

Blogger

If you are a blogger, chances are high that back in the day, you started your first blog at Blogger (blogspot). As things stand now, it is not possible for anyone to say that they have a blog on Blogger and not expect a couple of under the breath scoffs, and God forbid if you happened to mention it in front of a bunch of nerds, then you are in deep trouble. Preferences have changed over the years. Today, the order

is Wordpress for geeks who like playing with design and widgets, Tumblr for artsy people who prefer clean design coupled with social media elements in a blogging platform and Posterous for busy people who want an online presence but don't want the hassle of the work that goes into it.

Here are some things that you cannot do with Blogger: you cannot import your posts and comments from any other blog



service except Blogger (which means that it is not migration friendly); you can't upload common file formats such as PPT, DOC and PDF among others, and the storage space for uploading images is limited to a mere 1 GB. You cannot create contact forms within the web site; you cannot use the more contemporary CSS themes with Blogger, since it uses HTML coded themes; you cannot post from outside the service – you can only make blog entries via the web interface provided by Blogger; you cannot expect prompt customer support as you can with, let's say – Wordpress.

Replaced by: Mainly Wordpress, and then a host of next generation blogging platforms such as Tumblr, Posterous and TypePad.

Blu-ray and HD-DVD

Nothing deserves a space in this write-up as much as this particular technology. It has all the right ingredients – need-